

THE PARTY LEADER LESSON • LESSON 6 OF 6

Lead Your AI Squad



45 minutes, no prep. The hook: an AI agent does a multi-step job on its own — where your card is vague, it guesses forward. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Run the Quest worksheet (2 pp; typeable PDF included) · Slides (optional) · scrap paper (1 per student) · board · Teacher Guide	None — unplugged. Optional: projector; your AI account (with-devices block, p.2)	Print worksheets. Plan teams of 3. That's it.

OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Write a four-part **quest card** an agent can't misread. (Step 2; Exit #1)
- Do one **squad role** (planner, scout, critic) from the card alone. (Step 3; Exit #2)
- Review work with the **CHECK rubric**; write a specific run-it-back note. (Step 4; Exit #3)

ISTE 1.5.c

ISTE 1.7.c

CCSS ELA W.6.4

✓ WARM-UP — IT DID EXACTLY WHAT YOU SAID (7 MIN)

Your new party member: maxed stats, never sleeps, never complains — painfully literal. Last night's run:

"Guard the door." → Guarded the door. Only the door. The enemies came in through the window.

"Grab everything in the chest." → Everything. Including the cursed amulet with the obvious skull on it.

"Wait here." → Still waiting. It has been three in-game days.

Then ask: **whose fault was that — the party member's, or the orders?**

Bridge: "An AI agent does a multi-step job on its own — and where your card is vague, it guesses forward. That's why the leader checks. You'll never out-work it. You CAN out-lead it."

What if nobody laughs? Take a fourth order from the room and ruin it too: "Heal me" → healed you. Once.

Transition: "Today you learn the leader's loop: quest card, roles, check the loot — ship it or run it back."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THE PARTY LEADER'S LOOP (10 MIN)

Board: **QUEST CARD** → **ROLES** → **CHECK THE LOOT** → **SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK.**

QUEST CARD — four parts, in writing: **goal** (what winning means), **what we know** (who it's for, what the team has), **rules of the run** (length, tone, deadline), **done looks like** (the exact thing handed back). (If your class did the genie lesson: this is P.R.O. grown up.)

ROLES — nobody solos the raid: a **planner**, a **scout**, a **critic** — same card, one slice each.

CHECK THE LOOT — **accuracy** (facts match the card; every ✓ has a "how we know"), **taste** (fits the audience and tone — or could it be for anybody?), **done-ness** (everything the card asked for?). Weak work gets a run-it-back note: keep + fix.

Watch one get fixed — build it on the board, one labeled part at a time. Cursed order: *"Plan the game night."* → **Party leader's quest card:** "GOAL: get 6th graders to actually show up to Game Night. WHAT WE KNOW: Friday, gym, 6–8 pm; we have board games and two TVs. RULES OF THE RUN: school-appropriate, big readable title, 40 words max. DONE LOOKS LIKE: one flyer draft, ready to photocopy." Then, plainly: **"Party leaders don't do the quest twice. If you have to redo a party member's work, your quest card failed. Fix the card, not just the work."**

What if *"too long"? Count it — four lines. "Four lines now, or 'games all night' on the flyer later."*

Hand-out: "Page 1. Teams of 3. Pick your quest, then ONE card per team — everyone copies it. Six minutes."

ACTIVITY — RUN THE QUEST (22 MIN)

1. **Write the quest card (6 min):** teams of 3 (30 students = 10 teams) pick a quest on the worksheet — Game Night page or class magazine issue #1 — and write ONE card, all four parts.

What if *a team stalls on GOAL? "What would make you say we won?" Done early? A neighbor team tries to twist it.*

Switch: "Cards done. Now switch: for 8 minutes YOU play an AI agent. Take a role card. Silence starts now."

2. **Squad works (8 min):** each teammate takes a role card and works ONLY from the quest card, silently, on scrap paper. At 4 min: "Planners, slide your list to your Critic." The critic writes 3 upgrades to that plan. No questions — agents can't read minds. (Sana's squad: DeShawn plans, Lucia scouts, Sana critiques.)

What if *the class doesn't divide by 3? Team of 4: two critics. Team of 2: no critic — the leader does the taste check. Mid-round question? "It's not on the card."*

Swap: "Time. Pass your paper one seat left. You're the leader again — page 2."

3. **Leader review (8 min):** each leader runs the CHECK rubric (worksheet p.2) on the work in their hands, ticks SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK per check, and writes one run-it-back note. Leave the rubric slide up.

What if *a leader turns harsh? KEEP before FIX, and they read the note aloud to their party member.*

Into the exit ticket: "Loot checked. Last quest: one for your own life. Bottom of page 2, solo."

EXIT TICKET (6 MIN)

Worksheet p.2, solo: **#1** a quest card for a **real task in their own life**, all four parts; **#2** which role gets it first, and why; **#3** the check it would most likely fail, and what to look for. Collect; key: Teacher Guide, p.2.

What if *a student writes a wish ("help me with math")? "Which part would stop a stranger guessing? Add it."*

DIFFERENTIATION

Support: sentence starters (Teacher Guide, p.3). **ELL:** draft in the strongest language first, then translate.

Extension: a card so tight the critic can't land a note. **No devices:** built in.

With devices (optional — teacher's projected account only; students never log in):

1. **Paste** a team's card word for word. Add: "Do the planner's job, then the scout's."
2. **Review** it as a class with the CHECK rubric — SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK per check.
3. **Watch for** an invented fact ("games all night"), a skipped rule, an extra step.
4. **Fix the card, not the output:** add the missing rule, run it again, compare.
5. **Time:** 6–8 min. Swap in for one team's Leader review, or open day 2 with it.